GRADE 3

Curriculum Book

Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 3 - Curriculum Book

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Year theme: *Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs* ***Band:*** *3-5 ·* ***Audience:*** *3rd-grader · parent · teacher · admin* ***Owner:*** *Brand & SMM (Camille)*

Where ideas come from

Skills, hobbies, needs - and the eyes to notice.

3-line elevator pitch

"You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?"

- CASH, GRADE 3

"*Cash to Company third grade teaches your 8-year-old that business ideas don't come from magic moments — they come from three real things every kid already has: skills, hobbies, and needs they notice. Year 4 of a continuous K-12 mascot arc led by Cash, a gender-neutral coin — explicitly anti-hustle, evidence-based.*"

Parent-facing one-pager

TRY THIS

Spot it in the wild

Walk through your house. Find three things somebody made or sold. Write the name of one. Who do you think bought it, and why?

What this is

Cash to Company is a K-12 curriculum hosted by **Cash**, a gender-neutral animated coin who asks one question for 13 years: "*Which people, and how do you know?*"

What third grade covers

- **Skills, hobbies, needs** — the three circles where real ideas live.
- **The Promise Sentence** — "*My business will help ___ by ___.*"
- **Five ideas beats one idea** — brainstorming as a habit.
- **Defending your pick** — explaining why with evidence.
- **Profit is what's left** — first introduction to cost / price / left.
- **Honest vs. misleading** — first lesson on advertising.

What you'll hear at the dinner table

- "*Real ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs.*"
- "*Everyone is a way to say nobody.*"
- "*Honest claims build customers who come back.*"

The promise (what we won't do)

- Never asks about your family's money.
- Never says anyone is guaranteed to get rich.
- Never pressures your child to start a real business — this is a thinking program.

What to say when...

YOUR KID SAYS	YOU CAN SAY
"Why don't we have a [thing] like X family?"	"*That's a grown-up question. What about a business idea — what skill do you have?*"
"I want to start a real business."	"*What problem are you solving? Who's the customer? How do you know?*"
"Is this ad lying?"	"*Run the 4-point check. What does it actually promise?*"

One easy thing this month

Help your kid draw three big circles on a sheet of paper. Label them: skills, hobbies, needs. Fill in 3 each. Don't grade. Just listen.

Teacher-facing one-pager

WORDS TO KNOW

Skill
Something you have practiced enough to be good at.

Hobby
Something you do for fun, on your own time.

Need
A problem somebody has that they want solved.

Customer
The person who pays - not the person you wish would pay.

Idea
A skill, a hobby, or a need turned into a way to help someone.

Year in 5 sentences

G3 anchors the upper elementary band on **idea generation from real life**. Across 36 weeks, students draw the Skills/Hobbies/Needs Web, write a Promise Sentence, run a 5-Idea Sprint, defend a pick, learn cost/price/profit, sketch a logo, run an honest-vs-misleading ad analysis, and present a Capstone. Eight 2:30–3:00 Cash videos drive Mondays. Sensitivity policy: no family money probes.

Standards

- CCSS-Math.3.NBT, 3.MD (estimation, rounding, multi-step word problems)
- CCSS-ELA.SL.3.1 (collaborative discussions)
- C3.D2.Eco.3-5.1, .2 (specialization, scarcity)
- CASEL: Self-Awareness, Responsible Decision-Making

Weekly rhythm

Monday Cash + Q · Wednesday work block (30 min) · Friday share-out (15 min) · Tue/Thu vocab spine.

The 8 Cash-video CTAs

1. **V1 (W1)** Skills/Hobbies/Needs Web — bring it Friday.
2. **V2 (W7)** Promise Sentence — bring it Wednesday.
3. **V3 (W9)** 5-Idea Sprint — pair-share strangest one.
4. **V4 (W17)** Pair defense — 60 sec + 2 hard questions. (Cash fumble video.)
5. **V5 (W19)** Three numbers — cost, price, left — bring it Friday.
6. **V6 (W26)** Three logo drafts — vote with stickers.
7. **V7 (W28)** 4-point check on a real ad — bring it Wednesday.
8. **V8 (W35)** First-Try Fix journal — defend the fix.

What to say when...

STUDENT SAYS	TEACHER RESPONSE
"I have no skills."	"*You take care of a pet. You remember everyone's name. You make people laugh. Those are skills.*"
"We can't afford that at my house."	"*This year we don't talk about home money. We talk about hypothetical businesses.*"
"What's the right answer?"	"*What does your evidence tell you?*"

Admin pitch outline

MATH MOMENT

Tally five

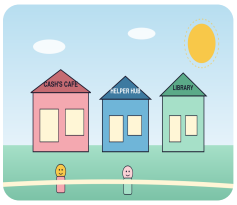
Ask five people: 'Would you buy this?' Tally yes and no with marks. Five marks each row. Did more say yes or no?

1. **Outcomes:** every G3 student creates a Skills/Hobbies/Needs Web, writes and defends a Promise Sentence, computes cost/price/profit on a hypothetical business, applies a 4-point check on advertising.
2. **Standards alignment:** CCSS-Math 3.NBT, 3.MD; ELA.SL.3.1; C3.D2.Eco. 3-5.1/.2; CASEL.
3. **Equity:** no family-money probes; mascot is gender- and culturally-neutral; equity-by-design.
4. **Evidence:** Fall 2026 pilot pre/post Jump$tart 3-5 + qualitative.
5. **Differentiator:** K-12 continuous mascot arc with a Capstone every year. JA's BizTown is a one-day field trip; we are a 36-week routine. EVERFI is sponsor-funded; we have no sponsor.

Hashtag bank (20)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real customers

Family, neighbors, classmates, teachers, the person at the corner store. Five real people beats one good guess.

#CashToCompany #LearnWithCash #CashSays #WhichPeopleAndHowDoYouKnow #ThirdGrade #3rdGrade #3rdGradeTeacher #TeachersOfInstagram #TeacherTok #TeachersFollowTeachers #FinLitTeacher #FinancialLiteracy #EntrepreneurshipForKids #ParentingTok #DinnerTableQuestions #NoHustleParenting #SkillsHobbiesNeeds #PromiseSentence #FiveIdeasBeatsOne #3-5Curriculum

Sample social posts

FAMILY TALK

Skill, hobby, or need?

At dinner, name one skill, one hobby, and one need somebody at the table has. Could any of them turn into a tiny business?

Kid-direct

1. "*My third-grader just made a 'Skills, Hobbies, Needs' web at the dinner table. Skills: pet care. Hobbies: drawing. Needs: kids forget their lunchboxes. Tag your tiny CEO.*" + V1 Short.
2. "*Bracelet stand at the school fair: $120 in. $30 out. Profit: $90. My third-grader just learned 'profit is what's left.' Excuse me while I cry.*" + V5 Short.
3. "*Cash made a deliberately bad business idea — the GLOW STICK BUSINESS — and asked my class to find the flaw. They DID. Cash to Company V4.*" + V4 Short.

Parent-direct

1. "*Cash to Company third grade: my kid is already using 'which people, and how do you know?' on her brother. I've created a monster. (K-12, one mascot.)*"
2. "*The financial-literacy program that doesn't promise wealth: Cash to Company. Their actual mascot says 'being wrong is the deal.' I'm in.*"
3. "*Looking for a non-hustle entrepreneurship curriculum for K-5? Cash to Company. K-12, one mascot. The mascot is a coin. The pedagogy is real.*"

Teacher-direct

1. "*Skills/Hobbies/Needs Web in third grade — a 5-minute CTA, and EVERY kid in my class found at least one idea they hadn't thought of. Cash to Company V1.*"
2. "*5-Idea Sprint in 5 minutes. My kids are now generating ideas as a habit. Cash to Company V3 unlocked this.*"
3. "*The 'Cash Fumble' video where Cash gets it wrong on purpose — kids LIVE for it. Critical thinking, age-appropriate, evidence-based.*"

FROM CASH

What I do, what I love, what I notice

Three questions. Three sentences. Three ideas. That's how a business starts - not with a logo, with a list.

KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 3 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Spending and saving - earning money, choices, opportunity cost.

CEE NS3
Productive resources, scarcity, and choice.

CCSS-MATH 3.MD
Measurement and data - survey customers, tally results.

CCSS-ELA SL.3.1
Engage in collaborative discussions - pitch and feedback.

CASEL Self-Awareness
Identify strengths, interests, and values.

C3 D2.Eco.1.3-5
Compare benefits and costs of choices.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it? — Cash

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